

Right Humpbacks and other species can be seen on whale-watching trips off the Bahia coast from July to October

Below The creamy fish stew of *moqueca* includes tangy lime-marinated fish and fresh tomatoes



Three Days in Espírito Santo and Bahia

The pretty, unspoiled towns and villages of these regions sit against a backdrop of Atlantic coastal rain forests and border some of the finest beaches in Brazil.

DAY ONE Visit the rain forests of the **Monte Pascoal National Park**, which shroud the peak first sighted by the Portuguese and hide jaguars among the trees. Continue to **Alcobaça**, the region's festival capital, whose streets are lined with crumbling 19th-century houses.

DAY TWO Take a boat trip from **Caravelas** to whale-watch and snorkel in the **Abrolhos Archipelago**. These waters are home to some of the most extensive coral reefs in the South Atlantic and are one of the best places in the world to see humpback whales, who calf here between July and December. Stay the night in Caravelas.

DAY THREE Drive south to the relaxing little fishing resort of **Itaúnas**, which sits nestled in dunes behind a string of magnificent beaches visited by three species of marine turtles.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

The state's main international hub is Salvador-Deputado Luís Eduardo Magalhães **airport**; domestic airlines fly into the smaller **Porto Seguro airport**; both have **car rental** facilities.

WHERE TO STAY

Vila Morena (inexpensive) in Itaúnas offers colorful and friendly bargain accommodations a stroll from the sea. www.vilamorena.com.br
Brisa dos Abrolhos (moderate) in Alcobaça is great for families. +55 73 3293 2022
Marina Porto Abrolhos (expensive) in Caravelas is the best hotel in the region, right on the beach. www.marinaportoabrolhos.com.br

TOURIST INFORMATION

Bahia: www.bahiatursa.ba.gov.br;
 Espírito Santo: www.setur.es.gov.br

